

Node.js Download and Installation Guide (Windows)

This document provides a complete step-by-step guide to download, install Node.js on a Windows laptop, and correctly configure the **Environment PATH**.

1. Prerequisites

- Windows 10 or Windows 11 (64-bit recommended)
 - Administrator access on the system
 - Stable internet connection
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2. Download Node.js

1. Open your web browser.
 2. Visit the official Node.js website: <https://nodejs.org>
 3. You will see two versions:
 - **LTS (Long Term Support)** – Recommended for most users
 - **Current** – Latest features (not recommended for production)
 4. Click **LTS** to download the Windows Installer (**.msi**).
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3. Install Node.js

1. Double-click the downloaded **.msi** file.
2. Click **Next** on the welcome screen.
3. Accept the **License Agreement** → Click **Next**.
4. Choose the installation location (default is recommended):

```
C:\Program Files\nodejs\
```

5. Click **Next**.
6. On the **Custom Setup** screen:
 - Ensure **Node.js runtime**
 - **npm package manager**
 - **Add to PATH** are all selected.
7. Click **Next**.
8. Click **Install**.

9. Click **Finish** after installation completes.

4. Verify Node.js Installation

1. Open **Command Prompt**.
2. Run the following commands:

```
node -v  
npm -v
```

3. If versions are displayed, Node.js and npm are installed successfully.

5. Check Environment PATH (Important)

Node.js installer usually adds PATH automatically. Verify it manually.

5.1 Open Environment Variables

1. Press **Windows + R**
2. Type `sysdm.cpl` → Press **Enter**
3. Go to **Advanced** tab
4. Click **Environment Variables**

5.2 Verify PATH Variable

1. Under **System variables**, select **Path**
2. Click **Edit**
3. Ensure the following paths exist:

```
C:\Program Files\nodejs\  
C:\Users\<your-username>\AppData\Roaming\npm
```

4. If missing:
 - Click **New**
 - Add the path manually
5. Click **OK** → **OK** → **OK**

6. Restart Command Prompt

After updating PATH:

- Close all open Command Prompt windows
- Open a new Command Prompt
- Re-run:

```
node -v  
npm -v
```

7. Test Node.js with a Sample Program

1. Create a file named `app.js`
2. Add the following code:

```
console.log("Node.js installation successful");
```

3. Run the file:

```
node app.js
```

4. Output should be:

```
Node.js installation successful
```
